

FICHE DE TD 3/3 • DIFFICILE

Anglais • Tle T

Family and social life

Anglais – classe de Terminale technique

Cette fiche d'intégration évalue la maîtrise synthétique des structures grammaticales complexes, du lexique spécialisé et des compétences communicationnelles (écrit/oral) dans des contextes professionnels réalistes.

EXERCICE 1 Grammar & Vocabulary in Professional Context : The Interview Process

Context : You are an HR Assistant at TechnoCam Ltd. You are reviewing a candidate's file and preparing the interview protocol. Complete the following tasks demonstrating command of advanced structures.

1. Tense Synthesis (Present Perfect Continuous / Future Continuous). Complete the memo below using only the verbs in brackets in the Present Perfect Continuous or Future Continuous. Justify each choice in one sentence (aspect : duration/unfinished vs. predicted ongoing action at future moment).

MEMORANDUM

TO : Hiring Committee

FROM : HR Dept

RE : Candidate M. Nkodo

Date : October 24, 2023

Mr. Nkodo (1. work) as a network administrator for seven years. By the time of the interview next Tuesday, he (2. complete) his current migration project. He (3. update) his CCNA certification recently. During the technical test at 10 :00 AM tomorrow, he (4. configure) a virtual router live. We (5. assess) his soft skills simultaneously.

2. Embedded Questions & Reporting. The Panel Chair wants indirect, polite formulations for the interview guide. Transform the direct questions into embedded questions (noun clauses) introduced by the prompts. Do not change the tense of the original verb unless logic demands it.
 - (a) Direct : "What specific routing protocols have you mastered?" → Prompt : Could you tell us ...
 - (b) Direct : "Did you lead the migration team?" → Prompt : We would like to know ...
 - (c) Direct : "How do you handle network downtime pressure?" → Prompt : The panel wonders ...
3. Phrasal Verbs & Prepositional Phrases (Professional Register). Replace the underlined informal verbs with a phrasal verb or prepositional phrase from the box, conjugating correctly. Two items are distractors.

carry out look into bring about account for
run up against put up with go through stand for

- (a) The audit revealed several security flaws.
 - (b) We cannot tolerate repeated breaches of protocol.
 - (c) The new firewall caused a significant improvement in latency.
 - (d) The IT team must execute the backup procedure nightly.
 - (e) The candidate must explain the gap in his employment history.
4. Question Tags (Pragmatic Function). Add the correct tag. Then, specify the intonation (Rising ↑ / Falling ↓) and the speaker's attitude (Confirmation seeking / Genuine uncertainty / Polite interest / Sarcasm) for each context.
- (a) "You've configured the VLANs correctly, ..." (Senior tech verifying a junior's work before deployment).
 - (b) "This candidate won't be available for night shifts, ..." (HR checking a constraint mentioned in the CV).
 - (c) "Let's proceed with the technical test, ..." (Chair inviting agreement to start).

EXERCICE 2 Critical Reading & Analysis : Anticipating L2 Needs at Work

Read the text below and answer the questions. Answers must be formulated in your own words ; no lifting.

"The Linguistic Ceiling : Why Technical Competence Isn't Enough" In the evolving landscape of the Cameroonian tech sector, a paradox persists. Engineers graduate with impeccable coding skills—Python, Java, C++—yet hit a 'linguistic ceiling' mid-career. The technical interview, often conducted in English by multinational partners, acts as the first filter. However, the real bottleneck emerges post-hiring : the daily stand-ups, the Agile retrospectives, the impromptu debugging sessions with a remote client in Lagos or London. Here, 'survival English' fails. The subjunctive mood in 'I suggest he reboot the server' carries legal weight in an SLA ; the modal nuance between 'The system might fail' (possibility) and 'The system could fail' (ability/conditional) dictates escalation protocols. Anticipating these needs requires a shift from General English to English for Specific Purposes (ESP) focused on pragmatic competence. It is not merely vocabulary acquisition (e.g., 'latency', 'throughput', 'downtime') but mastering illocutionary force : hedging a refusal to a client ('That would be difficult' vs 'We can't do it'), embedding criticism in a code review ('Have you considered refactoring this module?'), or negotiating scope creep ('Were we to extend the deadline, we would need additional resources'). Unfortunately, continuous professional development (CPD) budgets rarely allocate funds for language upskilling, viewing it as a 'soft skill' rather than a 'hard technical requirement'.

Until HR policies align linguistic KPIs with technical KPIs, the ‘linguistic ceiling’ will remain the invisible barrier to leadership roles for Francophone technicians.”

1. Inference & Lexical Precision. Explain the metaphor “linguistic ceiling” in this specific context. Why does the author distinguish between the “technical interview” filter and the “post-hiring” bottleneck? (2 pts)
2. Grammar in Context (Modality & Subjunctive). Analyse the semantic difference between the two modal examples in paragraph 1 (might vs could). Why is the subjunctive (reboot) used in the SLA example? Provide a second original example of the mandative subjunctive relevant to a Project Manager’s email. (2 pts)
3. Pragmatic Competence (Illocutionary Force). The text lists three speech acts : hedging a refusal, embedding criticism, negotiating scope creep. For each, identify the specific grammatical structure used in the text’s example (e.g., modal + aspect, embedded question, conditional inversion). Then, produce one original, contextually appropriate utterance for each speech act that a Senior DevOps engineer might use in a Slack channel. (3 pts)
4. Critical Evaluation. “Viewing language as a ‘soft skill’ is a strategic error in the tech sector.” Drawing exclusively on arguments from the text, write a concise argumentative paragraph (80–100 words) supporting or refuting this statement. Use at least two cohesive devices (linking words) and one embedded question. (3 pts)

EXERCICE 3 Integrated Writing & Speaking Simulation : The Career Development Plan

Scenario : You are a Technical Support Engineer (Francophone background) targeting a Team Lead position in 18 months. Your manager requires a Career Development Plan (CDP) focusing on “Anticipating L2 Needs”.

1. Writing Task (Formal Report Style – 180–220 words). Write the “Language Upskilling Strategy” section of your CDP. You must integrate the following constraints :
 - Target 3 specific professional situations (e.g., Incident Management Bridge Call, Stakeholder Demo, Performance Review).
 - For each situation : identify the key grammatical structure (choose from : Future Continuous, Present Perfect Continuous, Embedded Question, Phrasal Verb, Question Tag) and the specific lexical set required.
 - Propose one measurable action per situation (e.g., “Shadow 2 bridge calls/month”, “Complete ESP Module X”).
 - Use a formal register (passive voice, nominalization, hedging modals).
2. Speaking Preparation (Instruction Design). You must brief your English tutor (a native speaker) for a 45-min simulation session next week. Write the explicit instructions you will give them. Use the imperative and embedded commands (“I need you to...”

/ “Please ensure that...”). The instructions must cover :

- (a) Role-play scenario (choose one from your CDP above).
 - (b) Specific grammar focus (error correction on the target structure).
 - (c) Feedback criteria (fluency, accuracy, pragmatic appropriateness).
3. Recreational Transfer (Synthesis). In a short paragraph (50 words), explain how a specific recreational activity (e.g., competitive gaming, chess club, hiking group, theatre) develops a transferable “soft skill” (communication, leadership, stress management) relevant to the Team Lead role. Use one phrasal verb and one question tag naturally.